



IT FACTORY

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INTEGRATED BUSINESS SOLUTIONS

Having provided the best software solutions to the business houses worldwide for more than a decade, the Danish company is all set to carve a niche for itself in India. Excerpt from a candid interview with Mr. Carsten Sjørup, Chief Technology Officer, IT FACTORY, and Mr. Manpreet Singh, VP of Indian Operations, IT FACTORY

IT FACTORY is into providing open-end solutions to various business houses. Why is it that IT FACTORY has become one of the favoured destinations of business houses for integrated business services when there are so many open-end solution providers in the market?

There are three things that make IT FACTORY stand apart from its competitors.

- First and foremost our track record of continuously delivering solutions that add value for those who buy them. The add-on solutions that we have been providing to the IBM Notes platform such as CRM and HRM address a real need in the market.
- Secondly, we are now in the last stages of moving our entire business and product portfolio over to a new delivery model called Software as a Service (SaaS). Here, clients can simply access the solutions over the internet. There is no large upfront investment, just a monthly fee and no long installation roll-out process. That means you start getting value out of your new application much faster.
- And last but not least, we take care of our customers' concerns from the security to the smooth running of the applications by providing them with a platform for integrated solutions.

Because of these facts, we have been the leading provider of CRM, HRM, and BI solutions over the years.

Every business has different requirements for software solutions so how do you meet these demands individually?

IT FACTORY understands this aspect and is committed to providing the business houses with custom-made applications. For this, our 'Integrated Business Solutions' are sold through our business partners. We have designed the IT FACTORY Business Partner Program wherein our partners create extra value for customers by customising our solutions. In order to ensure that our customers continue to get best solutions, we offer technical pre-sales support, technical specifications and estimates, customisations, and integration as well as technical training to our business partners.

With more than 10 successful years in providing business solutions, what has been your business model so far?

Ever since IT FACTORY's inception in 1997, we have placed the utmost importance on customer satisfaction. We want our customers to subscribe to success by using the best solutions and add-on services available in the market. Our new business model is based on 'Software as a Service' (SaaS). It is a software application delivery model where a software vendor develops, hosts, and operates a web-based software application for use by customers over the Internet. Customers pay a monthly subscription fee for the use of the software. Also, as a channel-driven company, our Integrated Business Solutions are sold exclusively through our reliable business partners. This model has helped us in creating a mutually beneficial and profitable relationship with strategic importance to both parties.

IT FACTORY is present worldwide, predominantly in Europe, and the US. Heading towards Asia, don't you think that IT FACTORY needs to make its presence felt in the world's second largest emerging economy – India?

India is definitely on the top of our priority list as far as business expansion is concerned. We have two off-shore research and development centres currently running in India which we expect to grow by 100% in the near future. We have our eyes on cities like Delhi, Pune, and Chennai for expanding our operations. India represents a huge market for the it-enabled services and this is well understood by us.

In this competitive environment, how does IT FACTORY meet the ever-increasing demand for business solutions?

We are on a constant lookout for providing software solutions that are not only cost efficient but easy to apply as well. That is why we moved from traditional to web-based applications. We also have an excellent customer support service that works round-the-clock to ensure the smooth functioning of applications.

Which major companies are part of your clientele?

IT FACTORY has sold more than 1.3 million licenses to roughly 2,500 customers in North America, Europe, the Middle East, and Australia. IBM has been our premier business partner so far. This is to say that IBM, the world's largest IT company, promotes IT FACTORY solutions. IT FACTORY is a member of the IBM design team for portals and architecture.

How much emphasis do you give to employee satisfaction?

IT FACTORY believes that its employees are its asset. For this reason, we offer them a congenial environment, thereby helping their creativity to improve. We allow our employees to communicate freely and there are no barriers at any level. Perhaps, this is why we have many employees in the company who have been working with us ever since the company's inception. While other companies face the problem of high attrition rates, we can proudly say that we don't.

Considering that IT FACTORY emphasises the 'corporate social responsibility' factor, which community welfare programmes has the company come up with?

We have collaborated with various NGOs and self-help groups on running programmes for uplifting the under-privileged sections of society. Programmes for women empowerment by making them self-dependent, providing clean drinking water in schools, distribution of essential medicines, and increasing computer literacy among children are just a few of them. We are also working on measures to preserve the environment and increasing awareness about AIDS/HIV.